

TECHNICAL & BUSINESS WRITING

BSAI – 7TH SEMESTER

FALL 2025

PRESENTATION 2



RECAP

- **DEFINITION**

- What is Technical Writing?
- What is Business Writing?

- **CHARACTERISTICS OF TECHNICAL & BUSINESS WRITING**

- 1. Clarity / Accuracy
- 2. Conciseness
- 3. purpose
- 4. Audience

WHY TECHNICAL WRITING IS AN ESSENTIAL JOB SKILL

- 1. **Clarity and understanding** (to avoid costly mistakes by preventing misunderstandings for colleagues, clients, and stakeholders)
- 2. **Professionalism and credibility** (writing reflects competence, error-free documents build trust, poorly documented reports may damage your professional image)
- 3. **Efficiency & Productivity** - time is capital, time saving, prevents follow-up emails and clarifications. Clearer the document, faster is the response or action on it.)
- 4. **Persuasive & Influencing** – your clarity of thought and expression convinces your clients, builds trust, creates an impact, decides your success / failure
- 5. **Permanent Records and Legal Protection** - written records are permanent, clarity, precision, and accuracy ensure correct historical facts
- 6. **Global Communication** – written communication is most desired way of communication across regions and time zones.



REPORT WRITING - DEFINITION

A detailed account, result of investigation, a formal record of a procedure, an official document, objective communication, factual information, clear, accessible and easy, specific audience, helps in decision making / problem solving, purpose-driven, specific structure makes recommendations, examination of data, official.

PURPOSE OF REPORTS

- **To inform and update** – presentation of data, attendance records, project status, minutes of the meeting, sales reports etc
- **To analyze and interpret** – not mere presentation of data, but examination as well. Cause and effects, - market research report, financial reports for profit and loss
- **To Support Decision-Making** – provide evidences for informed choices, to avoid risk
- Cost-benefit analysis, feasibility reports
- **To Recommend and Persuade** – logical argument to convince..A proposal, a new program
- **To Solve Problems** – to investigate, identify root causes – a diagnosis report, technical report for some kind of failure, report of an incident
- **To record and Document** – permanent records for historical references

PURPOSE - CONTD

- **To ensure accountability and compliance** – individuals and departments are meeting their obligations, following rules – progress reports, Sales forecast reports
- **To get approval** - yes for a plan or a budget for a project, project proposals

TYPES OF REPORTS

- **1. Function & Purpose**
 - Informational reports, analytical reports, recommendation reports, persuasive reports
- **2. Frequency & Timing**
 - Routine / periodic reports, ad-hoc/special reports (one time, unique)
- **3. Format & Structure**
 - Formal Reports , informal reports
- **4. Content**
 - Business reports, scientific reports, academic reports, medical reports, legal reports, investigation reports
- **5. communication Level**
 - Vertical reports, horizontal reports, internal reports, external reports

CLASS ASSIGNMENTS ON REPORT WRITING

	Topic	Activity	CLOs
1.	Etymology, definition, purpose of Technical and Business Writing	Brainstorming	CLO 1: State purpose and quality of report (foundational concepts) CLO 4: Volunteer to share your knowledge
2.	Reason for mastering Technical & Business Writing	Listify	CLO 1: State purpose and quality of report (understanding the reason for studying the subject)
3.	Definition of a Report	Concept Web (Word Web)	CLO 1: State purpose and quality of report
4.	Characteristics of a Report	Report Fixing - Identify errors in reports (Pair work)	CLO 2: Apply different techniques and principles to prepare a report (correction of errors by applying knowledge)
5.	Types of Reports	Identifying types – Fill in the blanks (pair work)	CLO 2: Apply different techniques and principles to prepare a report

Sample Report 1: The Vague Project Update

To: Project Team

From: Alex C.

Date: 24 October 2023

Subject: Update on the thing we're working on.

1. Hey guys, just wanted to send an update. 2. So, I've been working on the backend part for the user login system. It's been going okay, but there are some issues. 3. The thing is kind of slow sometimes, especially when a lot of people try to use it at once. I think it might be the database queries, but I'm not totally sure. 4. I tried to fix the problem with the algorithm we talked about, but it didn't really help that much, and now there might be another problem with the way the data is being passed around, but I haven't had time to check. 5. Anyway, I'll keep you posted. Let me know if you have thoughts.
Cheers,
Alex

Sample Report 2: The Overly Technical Bug Report

To: The Development Team

From: Sarah L.

Date: 24 October 2023

Subject: Anomaly in the user interface rendering pipeline.

1. The client-side JavaScript function `renderDashboardComponents()` invokes a recursive | method `parseWidgetData()` which, upon iterating through the nested JSON object, encounters a cyclical reference. 2. This results in a stack overflow exception in the V8 engine, causing the UI thread to block. The try-catch block in the main event loop is not correctly handling this specific type of error. 3. It happens sometimes, but not always. I saw it when I clicked on the chart. 4. The root cause appears to be related to the object serialization/deserialization process initiated by the `fetchAPI` call, which does not adequately check for circular structures before passing the data to the rendering function. Further investigation is required to determine the precise point of failure in the data hydration phase. We need to fix this.
Sarah

Sample Report 3: The Unjustified Proposal

To: Head of Department

From: Ben W.

Date: 24 October 2023

Subject: New Database

1. I think we should stop using our current database and switch to a new one. 2. The current one is old and not as cool as the new ones that are out now. All the big tech companies are using this new database called "NeoGraphDB." It's really fast. 3. I read a blog that said it's better. 4. Our current system gets slow when we have a lot of users, and I think this would fix it. Also, it uses graph theory, which is more efficient for data relationships. 5. I've been looking into it for a while and I really think it's the way to go for the future of our project, and it would be a good learning experience for the team as well. Let me know what you think.
Ben

Investigate

REPORT IDENTIFICATION

1. A daily log file generated by a web server that records all visitor traffic, page requests, and error codes.
Type: _____
2. A document sent by a software engineer to their manager proposing the adoption of a new project management tool like Jira, including a cost-benefit analysis.
Type: _____
3. A research paper submitted to a scientific journal detailing the methodology and findings of a study on the efficiency of a new encryption algorithm.
Type: _____
4. A quick email from a project team member to the rest of the team summarizing what was accomplished in the last 24 hours.
Type: _____
5. A detailed document prepared by a board of inquiry analyzing the causes of a major data breach at a social media company, including findings of fault and systemic failures.
Type: _____
6. A quarterly financial statement (Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet) issued by a public company to its shareholders and the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC).
Type: _____
7. A police officer's written account of a traffic accident, including diagrams, statements from witnesses, and initial conclusions.
Type: _____
8. A memo from the CEO to all employees announcing a new company-wide holiday policy.
Type: _____
9. A user manual that explains how to install, configure, and use a new software application.
Type: _____
10. A professor's published analysis of the economic impact of the steam engine during the Industrial Revolution.
Type: _____
11. A doctor's "Discharge Summary" that outlines a patient's hospital stay, diagnosis, treatment provided, and follow-up instructions.
Type: _____
12. A report from the Marketing Department to the Sales Department providing data on the leads generated by a recent advertising campaign.
Type: _____
13. A contractor's proposal sent to a potential client, outlining the scope of work, timeline, and cost for building a new website.
Type: _____
14. A student's five-page paper analyzing the symbolism in Shakespeare's *Hamlet*, written for an English literature class.
Type: _____
15. A report written by a cybersecurity analyst for the IT Director after a phishing attack, focusing on how the attack happened and how to prevent a recurrence.
Type: _____

Investigate